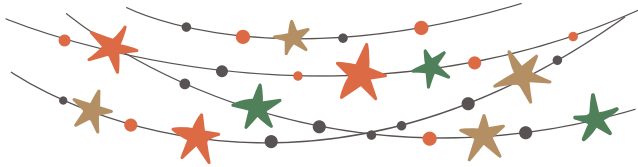


# Arike

## OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER

Welcome to the Arike Palliative Home Care Bulletin!

Within these pages, we share the stories and highlights of our work, emphasizing the difference it makes in the community. Your continued support helps us move forward and reach more people in need. Thank you for being with us on this journey.



### Spread the Joy of Christmas with Arike

This Christmas, let's bring joy and warmth to patients confined to their homes through Arike's Christmas Carol Programme. Volunteers will visit patients' bedsides, sing carols, share handmade greeting cards by school students, and distribute gifts and cakes to brighten their days. The carol will run in the evenings, and we invite anyone who wishes to join us in spreading festive cheer. Your generous contributions, no matter how small, can help us bring smiles and comfort to those in need. Let's come together to make this Christmas truly special.



### Beyond Medical Care: A Family's Fight for Survival

Mr. X, who battled liver disease for several years, was only diagnosed with cancer in its final stage, making the battle even tougher for him and his family.

Over the years, his wife worked as a domestic worker abroad, shouldering the financial burdens alone to ensure her husband could receive the care he needed. She returned home a month before his condition gravely deteriorated. Her return was meant to be temporary, a brief respite to support him; however, faced with his worsening health, she chose to stay by his side.

Their daughter, too, has shown remarkable resilience. After losing her husband to COVID-19, she has balanced raising two young children with working part-time jobs to keep the family afloat financially. Despite these challenges, she remains a pillar of strength for her children and her mother.

Throughout their ordeal, the family has maintained a significant level of independence in managing medical expenses. Even though they received sponsored care from Arike Home Care, they always made it a point to purchase their own medical supplies. This gesture allowed them to contribute back, ensuring that resources could be made available to others who are less able than they are to afford them.

Mr. X passed away last month after a long battle with disease. During our visit, the emotional gratitude expressed by his wife deeply moved our team. Her heartfelt thanks to all the sponsors, nurses, doctors, volunteers, and social workers of Arike resonated as a powerful testament to the difference our support makes in the lives of those we serve.

This family's story inspires us at Arike to continue our mission of supporting those facing life's most challenging tests.



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**24/7**  
Emergency  
Home Care

## ACTIVITIES

### Rehabilitation Training Programme for Paraplegic Patients

As part of our ongoing Rehabilitation Training programme for paraplegic patients and their guardians, we conducted a training session in association with Kudumbashree Mission Ernakulam and Arike, specifically for persons belonging to the Muvattupuzha and Tripunithura zones. This initiative focused on empowering paraplegic patients by promoting self-reliance and economic growth, including training in livelihood skills such as toiletry products manufacturing.



### ‘UNARV’ at CUSAT and Sree Narayana Guru College, Paingottoor

Arike, in collaboration with the Ernakulam Students Initiative in Palliative Care, organized the ‘UNARV’ palliative care training programme for the students of Sree Narayana Guru Arts and Science College, Paingottoor, and Cochin University of Science and Technology (CUSAT). The programme consisted of a series of comprehensive 10-hour sessions aimed at fostering compassion and developing practical caregiving skills among the participants.



## Arike Review Meeting- 'Koode'



On November 9th, a review meeting with volunteers and team members was conducted at the Arike Conference Hall in Palarivattom. This session served as an opportunity for participants to exchange ideas, evaluate the quality of care provided, and address any care-related concerns. The meeting encouraged open dialogue to resolve challenges and included expert guidance to improve practices. Arike remains committed to strengthening its connection with the community by offering ongoing training, fostering volunteer engagement, and maintaining transparent communication, creating a robust support system for patients, families, and caregivers.

## Volunteers Course in Palliative Care (VCPC)

Volunteers Course in Palliative Care is an ongoing monthly training programme that equips community members with essential knowledge and skills to support individuals in need of palliative care. Participants engage in theoretical learning and practical training, including home visits, to gain a comprehensive understanding of patient care and hands-on experience in providing compassionate support.



Join us for next month's VCPC. Call 703 4336 999 to register.

## Let's Talk: Daily Discussions on Palliative Care

'Let's talk' is a daily review to discuss the needs and treatment plans of our palliative care patients. Join our virtual meet-ups to collaborate, share insights, and improve the quality of care we provide.



## Awareness Session at Government Higher Secondary School, Panampilly Nagar

On November 26th, an awareness session on palliative care was held at GHSS, Panampilly Nagar, with the participation of around 200 students. The programme aimed to educate students about palliative care and highlight the vital role of students and communities. The event was organized by Vol. A.N. Sajeewan, with sessions led by Vol. Sivadasan, Community nurses Ms. Mereena, Ms. Chandhni, and the social welfare team of Arike.



## Awareness programme at Division 51, Cochin Corporation Thykoodam

On November 17, Arike Palliative Care, in collaboration with Kudumbashree, Thykoodam conducted an awareness workshop in Thykoodam, focusing on the importance of palliative care and community involvement in health initiatives. The event was inaugurated by the Hon. Division Councillor, Mercy Teacher, and presided over by Mr. Xavier P. Anthony, President of the Thykoodam South Residents Association. Key insights were shared by Ms. Smitha, Community Nurse at the Primary Health Centre, Champakkara, Arike Staff members and ASHAs. The discussions were further enriched by Mr. A.N. Sajevan, President of 'Njangal Und Koode Charitable Society', with community volunteers Ms. Rosemary, Ms. K.V. Gracy, and Mr. Joseph Vevukad. The workshop engaged 35 participants, inspiring them to explore ways to assist those in need through informed and compassionate community action.

## കുടുംബശ്രീ ബോധവൽക്കരണ ക്ലാസ്



കുടുംബശ്രീ ബോധവൽക്കരണ ക്ലാസ് കൗൺസിലർ മേഴ്സി ഉദ്ഘാടനം ചെയ്യുന്നു

വൈറ്റില▶ തൈക്കുടും കുടുംബശ്രീയുടെ നേതൃത്വത്തിൽ പ്രദേശവാസികളെയും ആശാവർക്കർമാരെയും ഉൾപ്പെടുത്തി പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ യിന്റെ പ്രസക്തി എന്ന വിഷയത്തിൽ ബോധവൽക്കരണ ക്ലാസ് നടത്തി. 'അരികെ' പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ സംഘടനയും ചമ്പക്കര നഗര പ്രാഥമികാരോഗ്യകേന്ദ്രവും ചേർന്നാണ് ബോധവൽക്കരണ ക്ലാസുകളെടുത്തത്. ഡിവിഷൻ കൗൺസിലർ മേഴ്സി ഉദ്ഘാടനം ചെയ്തു. തൈക്കുടും സൗത്ത് റെസിഡൻസ് അസോസിയേഷൻ പ്രസിഡന്റ് സേവ്യർ പി. ആന്റണി അധ്യക്ഷത വഹിച്ചു. യോഗത്തിൽ അരികെ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ സേഷ്യൽ വർക്കർ ഡോണൽ, അഭിജിത്ത്, നഗര പ്രാഥമികാരോഗ്യകേന്ദ്രം സ്റ്റാഫ് നഴ്സ് സ്മിത എന്നിവർ ക്ലാസുകളെടുത്തു. ഞങ്ങളുടെ കുടുംബ പാലിയേറ്റീവ് കെയർ ചാരിറ്റബിൾ സൊസൈറ്റി പ്രസിഡന്റ് എ.എൻ. സജീവൻ, റോസ്മേരി, കെ.വി. ഗ്രേസ്, ജോസഫ് വേവുകാട് എന്നിവർ സംസാരിച്ചു.

## Awareness Class at Kendriya Vidyalaya, Kadavanthra

On November 7<sup>th</sup>, we hosted a Palliative Care Awareness Day at Kendriya Vidyalaya Kadavanthra, engaging students and staff in a meaningful conversation about the importance of palliative care. The enthusiastic participation and genuine interest from the students highlighted the significant role that education and empathy play in supporting healthcare initiatives.



## Sensitization Workshop at IMA

On November 27<sup>th</sup> 2024, the Arike team conducted a sensitisation workshop at the Indian Medical Association (IMA) Cochin. This initiative aimed to foster a culture of continuous learning and professional development within the palliative care community, ultimately enhancing the quality of care provided to patients.

## Awareness Session at Thykoodam

On November 30<sup>th</sup>, an awareness session at Thykoodam highlighted the role of the community in supporting palliative care services. The event emphasised the power of collective compassion in transforming patient and family experiences. The event was successfully organized by Volunteers Sajeevan and Gracy. The programme featured informative sessions led by Palliative Care Volunteer Ajith Kumar and Palliative Care Nurse Saranya Sivan.



### Awareness Session at Our Lady High School, Thoppumpady

On November 30th, Arike along with Koode (Palliative Care Volunteers' Platform), conducted an awareness class at Our Lady High School Thoppumpady focusing on the need for supporting palliative care patients and their families. The session encouraged students to launch initiatives aimed at providing assistance to those receiving palliative care, fostering a spirit of compassion and community involvement among the students.



If your institution, company, residential association, or community is interested in hosting a similar awareness session, please feel free to contact Arike. We will be happy to organize it at no cost.

### Food Kit Distribution programme

Our generous donors have made a tangible difference in the lives of palliative patients. By providing monthly food kits, we aim to alleviate financial burdens and bring comfort to those grappling with serious illnesses. Thank you to our donors and partners for their unwavering support

### Support Our Mission

We warmly encourage you to contribute to Arike, enabling us to make a meaningful and lasting difference in the lives of individuals requiring palliative care.

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**MERRY**  
*Christmas*

AND HAPPY NEW YEAR

